

DIPLOMA IN EDUCATION PROGRAMME
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION
THE UNIVERSITY OF THE WEST INDIES, ST. AUGUSTINE

MUSIC

LESSON PLAN: #1 in Unit plan

TEACHER: Ms. Samantha Joseph **SCHOOL:** St. Joseph's Convent San Fernando

CLASS/FORM: Form 4 No. in class: 3 No of period(s): 1 Duration: 35 mins

Planning for the lesson

UNIT PLAN: Harmony – Chord Qualities and Triads Through Aural Learning and Technology Integration

TOPIC: Chord qualities: major, minor, diminished and augmented triads

CONCEPT map /graphic organizer of knowledge required for lesson or Unit (to be attached separately):

CURRICULUM INTEGRATION AREAS across subjects and materials needed

- **Mathematics**: adding semitones to build chords (4 + 3 = 7; 3 + 3 = 6; 4 + 4 = 8); patterns and symmetry.
- **Science**: physics of sound – several frequencies sounding together; consonance and dissonance.
- **Language Arts**: precise vocabulary (root, third, fifth, quality) and describing mood with adjectives; justifying answers orally.
- **Social Studies/Culture & HFLE:** chords in local music (calypso, soca, parang, steelband arrangements); respectful teamwork and peer feedback.

Materials: projector/TV with internet; 3 student devices; Coggle and Kahoot accounts; keyboard/piano; manuscript paper; mini whiteboards; printed back-ups.

The lesson plan:

PRE-KNOWLEDGE required (what knowledge/experiences do students bring to this lesson?)

Students are able to :

- Name and play notes on the keyboard and stave, including sharps and flats.
- Identify and construct intervals and state their qualities (major, minor, perfect, augmented, diminished), including counting semitones.
- Use the circle of fifths to order keys and their sharps/flats.
- Use a smartphone/browser to open a link and log in.

Strategies

Main strategy – Guided discovery through collaborative concept mapping (Coggle): students work out and record how the four chord qualities are built on a shared digital map, starting from the interval knowledge they already have. The teacher scaffolds, monitors the live map and asks probing questions (Section 2; Objectives 2, 3 and 5).

Supporting strategies:

- **Aural-first discovery**: hearing the same root played as four different chords (set induction and Section 3; Objective 4).
- **Direct instruction with modelling**: brief teaching of the interval structures of each quality (Section 1; Objective 1).
- **Questioning and mini-whiteboard checks**: quick formative checks in every sectional review.
- Peer checking: students swap branches and check each other's spellings by counting semitones (Section 2).
- **Guided keyboard practice**: building, playing and identifying triads (Section 3; Objective 4).
- **Gamified digital assessment (Kahoot)**: retrieval practice and instant feedback (final evaluation; Objectives 1–3).

Contingency plan: if Wi-Fi/devices fail, students complete the map on a printed template/chart paper and the quiz is run on mini whiteboards.

Goals

At the end of this lesson/Unit, pupils will be able to

- identify the four triad qualities (major, minor, diminished and augmented) by ear and from notation;
- construct triads on any root using interval structures and the circle of fifths;
- construct the triads of a major key and label them with Roman numerals and chord symbols;
- identify and play the primary chords (I, IV and V) in major keys and describe their roles;

- recognise common cadences and chord progressions by ear and in notation;
- harmonise a simple melody with primary chords and perform it on the keyboard; and
- collaborate respectfully and use digital tools (Coggle and Kahoot) to support their learning.

Objectives of the lesson	**Classification of objectives**	**Domain**
1. Define a triad and state the intervals above the root (third and fifth) in major, minor, diminished and augmented triads.	Knowledge - Remember	Cognitive
2. Construct and name major, minor, diminished and augmented triads on the roots C, G and F using interval structures.	Application - Apply	Cognitive
3. Explain how raising or lowering the third or the fifth changes the quality of a triad, by collaboratively building a concept map .	Comprehension/Analysis – Understand & Analyse	Cognitive
4. Play the four triad qualities on the keyboard and identify them by ear.	Guided response	Psychomotor
5. Contribute ideas respectfully and value peers' input during the collaborative task.	Responding - Valuing	Affective

SET INDUCTION – Time allotted: 4 minutes

Aural hook (3 mins): Teacher plays a C major triad, then C minor, C diminished, and C augmented on the keyboard. "The starting note is always C. What changed? How does each one make you feel?" Students describe the moods; the teacher notes that only one or two notes moved.

Recall (1 min): Students state the interval and quality from C to E, C to E♭ and C to G (M3, m3, P5) and the number of semitones in each.

Resources: keyboard/piano, projector.

SECTION 1 – What is a triad? Four chord qualities – Time allotted: 7 mins

Teaching points:

- A triad is a three-note chord built from a root, a third and a fifth, stacked in thirds (C–E–G).
- The quality depends on the intervals above the root: **major** = M3 (4 semitones) + P5 (7); **minor** = m3 (3) + P5 (7); **diminished** = m3 (3) + d5 (6); **augmented** = M3 (4) + A5 (8).
- Stacked thirds: major = M3 then m3; minor = m3 then M3; diminished = m3 then m3; augmented = M3 then M3.
- Change one note: lower the third (major → minor); lower the fifth (minor → diminished); raise the fifth (major → augmented).
- Common symbols: C, Cm, C° (Cdim), C+ (Caug). More than one system is in use, so state the one you use.

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Supporting strategy – Direct instruction & modelling: defines a triad (root, third, fifth) and builds C major on the projected keyboard/stave; shows how the interval above the root and the fifth decide the quality: major (M3 + P5), minor (m3 + P5), diminished (m3 + d5), augmented (M3 + A5).	Listen and observe; copy the four interval structures into notebooks; count semitones aloud (4, 3, 3, 4…) as the teacher builds C triads.	• Projector • keyboard diagram • slide with the four structures • manuscript paper
Supporting strategy – Guided practice: teacher models the "change one note" idea (lower the third: major → minor; lower the fifth: minor → diminished; raise the fifth: major → augmented), then sets G major and G minor.	Spell G major (G B D) and G minor (G B♭ D) on mini whiteboards; explain which note changed.	• Mini whiteboards • markers

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) Time allotted: 1 minute

Rapid whiteboard check: teacher asks "Which quality has a minor third and a diminished fifth?", "What is M3 + m3?", "What do you change to make C major into C minor?" Students answer on mini whiteboards; teacher gives immediate feedback.

SECTION 2 – Building the chord-quality map (Coggle) – Time allotted: 9 mins

Teaching points:

- Every quality is built the same way: root, then a third, then a fifth; only the size of the third and fifth changes.
- Answer key – **C:** C E G, Cm C E♭ G, Cdim C E♭ G♭, Caug C E G♯. **G:** G B D, Gm G B♭ D, Gdim G B♭ D♭, Gaug G B D♯. **F:** F A C, Fm F A♭ C, Fdim F A♭ C♭, Faug F A C♯.
- Using roots that are neighbours on the circle of fifths shows the same pattern repeating in different keys.
- Time plan: 1 min open map and demonstrate; 5 mins build; 2 mins peer check; 1 min agree the rule.

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Main strategy – Guided discovery with Coggle (technology tool 1, concept mapping): shares the link to the starter map: centre "Triads & Chord Quality" with four branches (Major, Minor, Diminished, Augmented), each showing its interval structure. Assigns a root to each student: A: C, B: G, C: F (neighbouring keys on the circle of fifths).	Open the Coggle link and sign in; under each of the four branches add the notes of the triad on their own root, its symbol (e.g., Gm) and how it sounds (one word).	• Coggle (free account) • Projector • 3 student devices • Wi-Fi/mobile data
Main strategy (continued) – Collaborative, constructivist task and peer checking: teacher watches edits appear live and asks probing questions ("Which note stayed the same in every chord? Which moved?"). Students then swap and check each other's branches by counting semitones.	Check a peer's spellings by counting semitones; correct or comment; colour-code the note that changes; type the rule on the central item: "Change the third or the fifth by a semitone to change the quality."	• Coggle • printed template (back-up) • teacher answer key

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) Time allotted: 1 minute

Map check and questioning: teacher checks the map against the answer key and asks: "Which chord has two minor thirds? Which note is the same in all four chords on your root? What changes between F major and F minor?" Misconceptions are corrected on the map.

SECTION 3 – Hearing and playing chord qualities – Time allotted: 5 mins

Teaching points:

- Typical sound: major – bright and stable; minor – darker; diminished – tense and unstable; augmented – unsettled and "floating". These are general descriptions, so students may add their own words.
- To play a triad: find the root, count 4 or 3 semitones up for the third, then count to the fifth (7, 6 or 8 from the root).

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Supporting strategy – Aural identification ("Name that chord"): teacher plays four triads in mixed order on the keyboard without naming them; then guides students to describe how each sounds (bright/stable, darker, tense, unsettled).	Listen and write the quality of each chord on mini whiteboards; compare answers; describe the sound in one word.	• Keyboard/piano • mini whiteboards
Supporting strategy – Guided keyboard practice: each student builds triads on their own root by counting semitones from the root and plays two assigned qualities (A: major and minor; B: minor and diminished; C: major and augmented). Teacher observes with a checklist.	Play assigned triads at the keyboard; classmates identify the quality by ear and by sight; correct errors.	• Keyboard (or on-screen keyboard app on a phone) • observation checklist

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) Time allotted: 1 minute

Observation checklist and immediate feedback: teacher notes whether each student built the triads correctly, played accurately and identified qualities by ear (evidence for Objectives 4 and 5) and corrects errors on the spot.

CLOSURE (How will you end the lesson?)– Time allotted: 2 minutes

Each student completes, aloud: "To change a major triad into a minor triad, I … ." Each adds one question to a "Parking lot" branch on the Coggle map (used to plan the next lesson). Teacher previews the next lesson: triads on every degree of a major scale.

FINAL EVALUATION – Time allotted: 5 minutes

Supporting strategy – Kahoot (technology tool 2, digital assessment): a 5-question multiple-choice quiz (about 20–30 seconds per question, plus joining time). Students join with the game PIN; the Kahoot report is downloaded afterwards for item analysis.

Reasonable level of achievement: each of the 3 students scores at least 4/5 (80%); any item missed by two or more students is re-taught at the start of the next lesson.

Related objectives to be tested: Objectives 1, 2 and 3 (Kahoot). Objectives 4 and 5 are assessed by teacher observation (Sections 2–3).

Table of Specification (weighting: Objective 1 – 2 marks, 40%; Objective 2 – 2 marks, 40%; Objective 3 – 1 mark, 20%; total 5 marks):

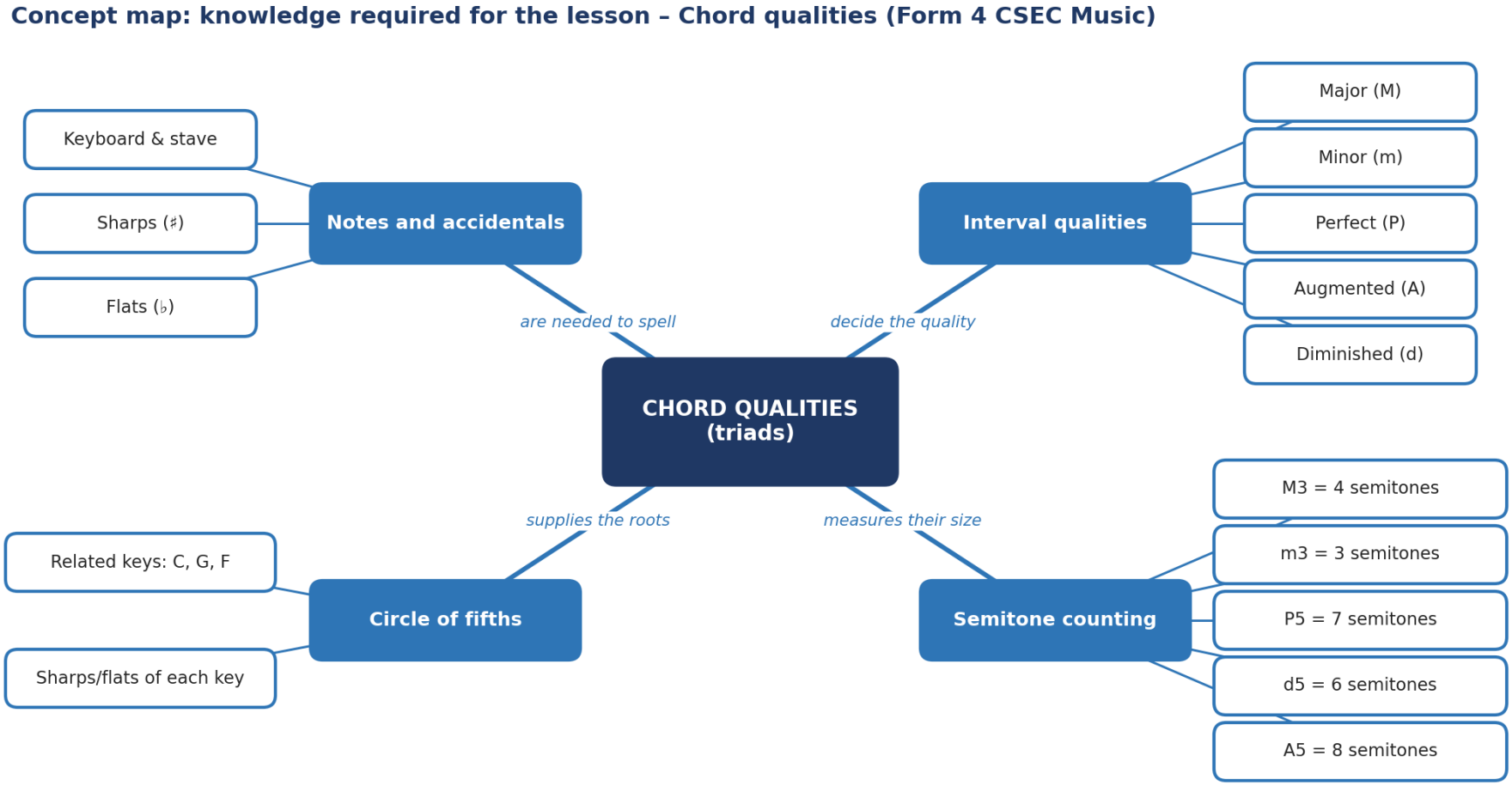
Table of Specification

Q#	Objective	Domain/Level	Kahoot Item
1	1	Cognitive - Remember	Which triad has a major 3rd and a perfect 5th above the root? (Major)
2	1	Cognitive - Remember	Which triad is built from two minor thirds stacked? (Diminished)
3	2	Cognitive – Apply	Which notes make a G minor triad? (G B♭ D)
4	2	Cognitive - Apply	What quality is the triad C E G♯? (Augmented)
5	3	Cognitive - Understand/Analyse	To change a major triad into a minor triad, you… (lower the third by a semitone)

FOLLOW-UP ACTIVITIES/LESSON:

- **Homework:** spell all four triads on D and B♭ (roots from the circle of fifths) and add them to the Coggle map.
- **Re-teaching:** use the Kahoot report to identify items missed by two or more students and begin the next lesson with those.
- **Next lesson:** triads on each degree of a major scale (qualities of I, ii, iii, IV, V, vi, vii°). **Extension:** play the C major scale triads on the keyboard and identify each quality by ear.

Concept Map:


Concept map: knowledge required for the lesson – Chord qualities (Form 4 CSEC Music)
CHORD QUALITIES (triads)
are needed to spell
decide the quality
supplies the roots
measures their size
Notes and accidentals
Keyboard & stave
Sharps (♯)
Flats (♭)
Interval qualities
Major (M)
Minor (m)
Perfect (P)
Augmented (A)
Diminished (d)
Circle of fifths
Related keys: C, G, F
Sharps/flats of each key
Semitone counting
M3 = 4 semitones
m3 = 3 semitones
P5 = 7 semitones
d5 = 6 semitones
A5 = 8 semitones